

Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

Becoming a Tree

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: patience.

For use in your own home. Please don’t share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

Some things can't be hurried. If you keep trying and wait, you grow when you are ready.

Say it together

Good things take time.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
seed	a tiny thing that a plant grows from	pinch your fingers into a tiny dot
soil	the earth that plants grow in	rub your fingers together like crumbly dirt
root	the part of a plant that grows down into the ground	wiggle your fingers downward
sprout	a new little plant pushing up	push one hand slowly up through the other
patient	able to wait calmly	fold your hands and breathe

A gentle note

Patience is not sitting still and being quiet. Oakie keeps trying the whole time.

Some beans won't sprout. Plant a few extras so every child has something to watch, and treat a seed that doesn't grow kindly.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

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Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



The kind worm

Earthworm

Tells Oakie to be patient



The passing bird

Song sparrow

Tells Oakie about sunlight and wind



The hungry deer

White-tailed deer

Nibbles Oakie's leaves, and is later forgiven



The squirrel

American red squirrel

Lives in the grown-up tree



The little blue bird

Eastern bluebird

Visits Oakie when he's a tree

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How did they feel?

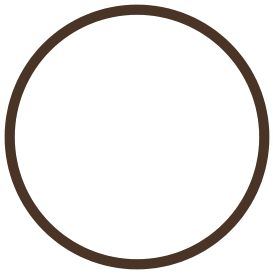
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Oakie lies in the dark soil.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

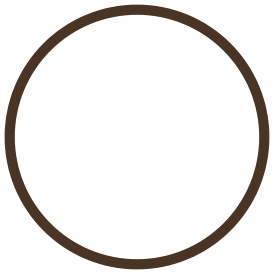


Moment 2

A root goes down and a shoot goes up.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

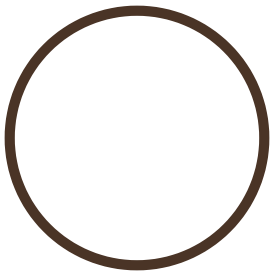


Moment 3

Oakie gives the little seed the worm's advice.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



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Story in order

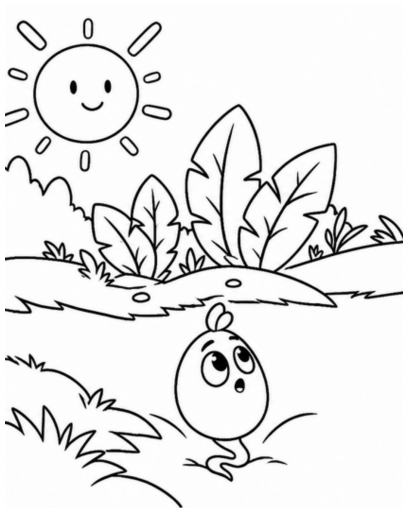
Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

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Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

seed a tiny thing that a plant grows from

seed seed

soil the earth that plants grow in

soil soil

root the part of a plant that grows down into the ground

root root

Oakie the hero of the story

Oakie Oakie

Write your name

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Draw your own story

Oakie showed patience. Draw a time when you showed patience too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

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Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Grow a bean

You need: Bean seeds, clear cups, damp paper towels, a sunny window

Put a damp paper towel inside a clear cup and slide a bean between the towel and the cup so you can see it. Keep it damp. Check every day and draw what you see: the root going down, the shoot going up. Say the worm's words when nothing seems to happen.

Plant a seed

Plant a bean in a cup of soil. Water it and watch it grow. How many days until you see a sprout?

Patience timer

Set a timer for one minute and sit very still, like a seed waiting underground. How did it feel?

Acorn hunt

In autumn, look for acorns under oak trees. Can you find one with its little cap?

Draw what you made

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The real animals

The animals in Becoming a Tree are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



The kind worm

Earthworm

A huge earthworm found in South Africa in 1967 was 6.7 metres long!



The passing bird

Song sparrow

A song sparrow's heart beats about 450 times a minute.



The hungry deer

White-tailed deer

A white-tailed deer can leap 3 metres high and 9 metres in one bound.



The squirrel

American red squirrel

Its loud chatter warns other squirrels to stay away.

Story or real?

The book's worm is green and striped. Real earthworms are usually pink, brown or reddish, but they really do live right next to seeds in the soil.

Where they really live

The book's forest has no name, so we picked Shenandoah National Park, in the Blue Ridge Mountains. Its woods are mostly oak and hickory, and deer are everywhere.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/becoming-a-tree

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Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



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Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

What do you think this story is about? How do trees start?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 1

What did Oakie want more than anything at the start?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 2

How do you think Oakie felt when he pushed and nothing happened?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 3

Why did Oakie decide to keep growing after the deer nibbled his leaf?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 4

What are you waiting for, or getting better at, little by little?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 5

What would you tell a little seed who wants to grow up fast?

Becoming a Tree, talk card 6

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Patience hero

This is to say that

_____

showed patience, just like Oakie.

Good things take time.

_____ _____

Signed Date

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